

I Will Always Love You (Rhythm Guitar) -- Dolly Parton

Dolly Parton, 1974. Written and recorded by Dolly. About 66 BPM, est.

This is Dolly's original country ballad, not the Whitney Houston power-ballad version.

Sparse Nashville arrangement. The guitar supports the vocal and never competes with it.

I haven't verified exactly which guitar parts are on the record. This is built from the song's overall Nashville-ballad sound.

Instrument: Stratocaster (HSS). Neck or position 4 (neck+middle) for rhythm. Neck pickup for the fills.

GP-5 only, Stratocaster (HSS), no pedalboard.

AMP: Dark Twin + CAB: EVM112 IR (User IR 5)

A blackface Twin is the default Nashville clean. Big headroom, a smooth top, no breakup.

EVM112 is the loaded guitar cab with a flat, hi-fi response. It suits a clean tone better than the V30's mid bark.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 12.

Low. Ballad notes need to decay naturally. This only catches single-coil hum between phrases.

PRE -- COMP (Ross), always on.

Sustain: 35, VOL: 55.

Ross-style squash is a country staple. 35 evens out soft strums and adds a bit of sustain to held chords. It doesn't sound pumped.

DST -- Green OD, on CTL.

Gain: 18, Tone: 55, VOL: 68.

Barely any drive. Mostly a level and mid push so the fills sit above the vocal. Gain 18 just rounds the attack.

AMP -- Dark Twin, always on.

Gain: 28, VOL: 62, Bass: 45, Middle: 45, Treble: 58, Bright: off.

Clean with lots of headroom. Bass 45 keeps it out of the piano's low end. Bright off, because single coils plus Bright plus Treble 58 is ice-pick territory.

CAB -- User IR 5 (EVM112), always on.

VOL: 60.

EQ -- Guitar EQ 2, always on.

100Hz: -2, 500Hz: 0, 1kHz: 0, 3kHz: +1, 6kHz: -2, VOL: 50.

Low cut makes room for the bass and piano. +1 at 3kHz gives the pick attack some definition. -2 at 6kHz takes off the string zing.

MOD -- off. No modulation. Nashville ballad clean stays straight.

DLY -- Analog, on CTL.

Mix: 18, Time: 450ms, F.Back: 20, Trail: on.

About an eighth note at 66 BPM. Two or three soft repeats thicken the fills between vocal lines. Trail on so the last repeat doesn't get chopped when you step off CTL.

RVB -- Spring, always on.

Mix: 22, Decay: 40, Trail: on.

Classic Fender spring. It gives the room a little air. 22 keeps the chords from going wet.

CTL footswitch

On CTL: DST (Green OD), DLY (Analog).

- **CTL off** -- Rhythm. Clean compressed Twin with spring. Soft strums and arpeggios under the verses and choruses. This is the resting state the patch loads into.

- **CTL on** -- Lead. About +3dB of level from the Green OD, a slight edge, and eighth-note analog repeats. Use it for the fills between vocal phrases and the instrumental turnarounds.

Engage CTL for fills and turnarounds. Step off before Dolly comes back in. During the spoken section, stay on CTL off and play very softly.